



Medford School Committee

Medford, Massachusetts 02155

MEMORANDUM

TO: All School Committee Members

FROM: Superintendent Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent

POSTING DATE: April 22, 2021

MEETING DATE: April 26, 2021

RE: Committee of the Whole Meeting

Please be advised that on Monday, April 26, 2021 at 5:00 PM, there will be a Committee of the Whole Meeting held through remote participation. The purpose of the meeting is to identify the members of an Advisory Committee to rename the Columbus Elementary School.

Pursuant to Governor Baker's March 12, 2020 Order Suspending Certain Provisions of the Open Meeting Law, G.L. c. 30A, §18, and the Governor's March 15, 2020 Order imposing strict limitations on the number of people that may gather in one place, this meeting of the Medford School Committee will be conducted via remote participation to the greatest extent possible. Specific information and the general guidelines for remote participation by members of the public and/or parties with a right and/or requirement to attend this meeting can be found on the City of Medford website, at www.medfordma.org. For this meeting, members of the public who wish to listen or watch the meeting may do so by accessing the meeting link contained herein. No in-person attendance of members of the public will be permitted, but every effort will be made to ensure that the public can adequately access the proceedings in real time, via technological means. In the event that we are unable to do so, despite best efforts, we will post on the City of Medford or Medford Community Media websites an audio or video recording, transcript, or other comprehensive record of proceedings as soon as possible after the meeting.

The meeting can be viewed through Medford Community Media on Comcast Channel 22 and

Verizon Channel 43 at 5:00 p.m.

Join Zoom Meeting

<https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/j/98188625305>

Meeting ID: 981 8862 5305

One tap mobile

+19292056099,,98188625305# US (New York)

+13017158592,,98188625305# US (Washington DC)

Dial by your location

+1 929 205 6099 US (New York)

Meeting ID: 981 8862 5305

Find your local number: <https://mps02155-org.zoom.us/u/abAVqt1W3g>

Additionally, questions or comments can be submitted during the meeting by emailing medfordsc@medford.k12.ma.us. Those submitting must include the following information:

- 1) Your first and last name
- 2) Your Medford street address
- 3) Your question or comment

The agenda will be as follows:

- Creation of an Advisory Committee to rename the Columbus Elementary School

ADVISORY COMMITTEE SELECTION

On April 26, 2021, a Committee of the Whole will be held to select and confirm the 23 voting members Advisory Committee and one ex officio member as follows:

1. **The** individuals (up to three) selected from the Columbus School staff, **Principal Kathy Kay**, and the **one** MHS student will be announced.

2. Each School Committee Member will select two members for the Advisory Committee from the valid applications received and will state the names publicly. In the event that an applicant is selected by more than one School Committee Member, the members will continue to name applicants until a total of **fourteen** Advisory Committee members have been named by the School Committee.
3. **Three** additional names will be selected by lottery from the remaining applicants.
4. One of the Mayor's appointments will serve as Chair of the Advisory Committee. The Chair will be responsible for scheduling meetings, posting meetings, chairing meetings and organizing a presentation to the School Committee once the final names are determined. The Chair will be a voting member of the Advisory Committee. The Mayor will announce the Chair of the Committee prior to the selection of other members. Current School Committee members will not be considered for this position.
5. In the event the committee membership reaches an even number, the Mayor will make an additional selection from the pool of applicants.
6. The Mayor will reach out to the Medford Historical Society, Historical Commission, and/or Historical District Commission to enlist the help of a member who will serve as a resource to the Advisory Committee. The historian will be an ex officio (non-voting) member.

PARTICIPATION BY THE COLUMBUS SCHOOL STAFF and STUDENTS

In recognition that the staff and students of the Columbus School are dedicated to their school, the School Committee requests the Principal to create a representative group of staff to solicit input from their colleagues. Additionally, student input is highly desirable and if it is feasible student participation will be encouraged in any way the Principal deems to be workable in this very short period of time.

1. By April 16, 2021, The Principal of the Columbus or her designee as well as up to three staff members selected by their peers will be appointed as voting members to the Advisory Committee.
2. Families of the Columbus Elementary School community are urged to apply for membership on the Advisory Committee through the public application process or to submit their suggestions via the suggestion form;
3. By April 16, 2021, a Medford High School student who attended the Columbus School, is a member of the C.C.S.R., and who is able to make the time commitment will be selected by his/her/their peers to be a member of the Advisory Committee. In the event that there is no applicant interested in the role, the principal of Medford High School may select another member of the high school community.

WORK OF THE ADVISORY COMMITTEE

1. At the April 26 Committee of the Whole Meeting, a list of the names submitted for consideration will be made public and forwarded to the Advisory Committee.
2. A file containing the emails from community members on the topic of the renaming will be made available to the Advisory Committee members so that all Advisory Committee members are aware of the opinions and concerns expressed by our community.
3. The Advisory Committee will develop criteria for evaluating the names. The Advisory Committee will determine the process for vetting the names, narrowing the field and submitting no more than three finalists to the school committee.
4. Press relations will be directed through the Advisory Committee chair and members of the Advisory Committee are urged to send press contacts to the Chair;

5. Advisory Committee meetings are public meetings and must follow all requirements of the Open Meeting Law;
6. The Superintendent will provide a note-taker and create minutes;
7. It is expected that the Advisory Committee will need to meet three to five times and a majority of voting members will be required to reach a quorum for the meeting;
8. The Advisory Committee will hold at least one public hearing or issue one public input survey to solicit feedback on the options they are considering per the charge of this resolution as at least one of their meetings;
9. Advisory Committee members may withdraw from participation by notifying the Chair and will not be counted in subsequent quorum and voting requirements.
10. Removal of a member is permitted by a majority vote of the advisory committee.
11. The Chair will notify the remaining members of the Advisory Committee of the reduction in membership. No new members will be added to the Advisory Committee due to vacancies;
12. While consensus is always preferred, a simple majority of the total number of Advisory Committee members will be required to select up to three names that will be forwarded to the school committee. A majority vote of the total number of committee members, and not a vote of the quorum present is required for this vote.
13. The Advisory Committee will present their recommendations for the new name(s) of the Columbus Elementary School no later than May 24, 2021. A presentation will be given explaining the way that the recommendation was arrived at and why the selected name(s) were chosen.
14. If a majority of the advisory committee votes to recommend a timeline change to the School Committee, they may do so. At that time the School Committee will vote to approve or decline this recommendation. Timeline changes shall not exceed a final date of July 31, 2021.

FINAL SELECTION OF THE NEW NAME

Once the Medford School Committee has received the names and presentation, the Committee will vote either that evening or at a subsequent meeting not later than June 7, 2021 to approve the recommendation, given the authority for naming of public school buildings the School Committee's authority alone, per Massachusetts General Law.

Dr. Marice Edouard-Vincent,
Superintendent of Schools